

Teacher Guide

Heidi · Chapter 3: Lesson 03 - In the Grandmother's Hut + Two Visitors · Grade 3

Lesson Overview

Use this guide to introduce the chapter, support close reading, and prepare students for discussion and writing. This guide is designed for a 60-minute instructional period or two 30-minute sessions.

Measurable Objectives

- Students will be able to Identify and describe the main characters (Heidi, Grandfather, Grandmother, Deta, Peter) using evidence from the text (RL.3.3)
- Students will be able to Define 4 key vocabulary words (delicate, fierce, frail, struggled) using context clues and apply them in sentences (L.3.4)
- Students will be able to Sequence the major events of Heidi's visit to Grandmother's hut and explain why each event is important (RL.3.1)
- Students will be able to Make inferences about character feelings and motivations based on their actions and dialogue, such as why Grandfather agrees to fix Grandmother's cottage and why Heidi resists leaving with Deta (RL.3.3)
- Students will be able to Engage effectively in collaborative discussions by building on others' ideas, asking clarifying questions, and providing text evidence to support thinking (SL.3.1)
- Students will be able to Write narratives to develop real or imagined experiences or events using effective technique, descriptive details, and clear event sequences (W.3.3)

Standards

Reading Literature

- **RL.3.1** — Ask and answer questions to demonstrate understanding of a text, referring explicitly to the text as the basis for the answers.
- **RL.3.3** — Describe characters in a story (e.g., their traits, motivations, or feelings) and explain how their actions contribute to the sequence of events.
- **RL.3.5** — Refer to parts of stories, dramas, and poems when writing or speaking about a text, using terms such as chapter, scene, and stanza; describe how each successive part builds on earlier sections.

Writing

- **W.3.3** — Write narratives to develop real or imagined experiences or events using effective technique, descriptive details, and clear event sequences.
- **W.3.4** — With guidance and support from adults, produce writing in which the development and organization are appropriate to task and purpose.

Language

- **L.3.4** — Determine or clarify the meaning of unknown and multiple-meaning word and phrases based on grade 3 reading and content, choosing flexibly from a range of strategies.
- **L.3.5** — Demonstrate understanding of figurative language, word relationships, and nuances in word meanings.

Speaking and Listening

- **SL.3.1** — Engage effectively in a range of collaborative discussions (one-on-one, in groups, and teacher-led) with diverse partners on grade 3 topics and texts, building on others' ideas and expressing their own clearly.
- **SL.3.3** — Ask and answer questions about information from a speaker, offering appropriate elaboration and detail.

Materials Needed

- Heidi, by Johanna Spyri (Classic Books for All edition), Chapter 3, for each student.
- Classic Books for All Heidi Student Workbook.
- Pencil and notebook.
- Whiteboard and markers.
- Optional: Drawing paper and colored pencils.

Get Ready to Read

Quick-write prompt

"What is something kind you have done for someone who needed help?"

Implementation

- Write this question on the board: 'Think about someone you know who needed help. What did you do, or what did you wish you could do for them?'
- Give students 2–3 quiet minutes to write their answer in their journal or on a piece of paper.
- Ask students to share their answer with their neighbor.
- Bring the class back together and tell students: 'In today's chapters, Heidi meets an old blind woman who needs help. As you read, look for the ways Heidi tries to help her.'

Connection tip: Connecting to personal experiences of helping others prepares students to understand Heidi's kindness and actions during close reading.

Words to Know Mini-Lesson

Mini-lesson

1. delicate (*page 51*)
2. fierce (*page 38*)
3. frail (*page 57*)
4. struggled (*page 46*)

Activities

Introduce words with context

- Write each word on the board.
- Read the sentence from the book containing the word.
- Think-aloud: "What clues help me understand this word?"
- Example for *struggled*: "She started running so fast that Peter struggled to keep up." (p. 46) — Look at the action words around the word. Heidi is running very fast. Peter is trying to stay with her but cannot. That helps you figure out what struggled means.

Partner practice

- Assign partners.
- Each pair gets two to three vocabulary words.
- Partners find the word in the text and discuss what it might mean.
- Use sentence: "I think _____ means _____ because the text says _____."

Quick check

- Call on pairs to share definitions.
- Confirm or clarify meanings.
- Post vocabulary words on Word Wall.

Guided Reading with Pause Points

Section 1: pages 38–40

Read from Every morning, Peter returned with his goats. ...

Pause and ask:

1. Why did Grandfather sometimes tell Heidi to stay inside?
2. The word 'fierce' describes the wind. What does fierce mean? Use the sentence on page 38 to help you.
3. Why do you think Peter felt sad on the days Heidi could not go to the pasture?

Section 2: pages 40–44

Read from As it grew dark, Peter knew it was time to go. ...

Pause and ask:

1. How did Heidi and Grandfather travel to Peter's grandmother's house?
2. Why did Grandmother ask Brigida to tell her what Heidi looked like?
3. Why do you think Heidi started crying when Grandmother said everything was dark for her?

Section 3: pages 44–48

Read from Grandmother tried to comfort Heidi. ...

Pause and ask:

1. What did Heidi ask Grandfather to do for Grandmother's house?
2. Grandfather fixed the shutter and the roof. What does this tell you about how Grandfather felt about helping Grandmother?
3. How did Grandmother's feelings change after Heidi began visiting her?

Section 4: pages 50–53

Read from Two winters had passed. ...

Pause and ask:

1. Why did the parson visit Grandfather?
2. Grandfather said he wanted Heidi to be free and happy as a bird. What do you think he meant by that?
3. The parson left Grandfather sadly. Do you think the parson was a kind man or an unkind man? Use words from the story to explain your answer.

Section 5: pages 53–57

Read from It was Heidi's aunt Deta. ...

Pause and ask:

1. Where did Aunt Deta want to take Heidi?
2. The word 'frail' describes Grandmother at the end of the chapter. What does frail mean? Use the sentence on page 57 to help you.

3. Heidi started running fast toward Frankfurt after Deta promised she could bring Grandmother soft white rolls. What does this tell you about how Heidi felt about Grandmother?
4. At the very end, Grandmother says the days are long and dull without Heidi. How do you think Grandmother felt when Heidi left? Use two words from the story to support your answer.

Read-aloud tip: After each pause point, ask students to point to the sentence in the text that helped them answer the question.

Think About the Story — Answers + Inferential Thinking

What did Grandfather use to bring Heidi down the snowy mountain to visit Grandmother?

Grandfather came out with a big sled, wrapped Heidi warmly, and set her on it, then held her securely as they shot through the winter landscape. (p. 40).

Who told Heidi that a loose shutter was banging and that the cottage rattled and creaked?

Peter's grandmother told Heidi that she could hear shutters banging and that the cottage rattled and creaked, with the wind coming in through every crack. (p. 42).

What did the parson want Heidi to do that her grandfather refused to allow?

The parson wanted Heidi to attend school, but Grandfather refused and said he did not want her to go. (p. 51).

Where did Aunt Deta say she was taking Heidi when she came to visit?

Aunt Deta said she was taking Heidi to Frankfurt, where a rich family needed a friend for their daughter who could not walk. (p. 53).

What did Heidi ask Grandfather to bring to Grandmother's house the very next morning?

Heidi asked Grandfather to bring nails and a hammer to fix the loose shutter and the other things falling apart in Grandmother's house. (p. 46).

What did Deta promise Heidi she could bring back to Grandmother as a gift?

Deta promised Heidi she could bring soft white rolls back to Grandmother, because the black bread was too hard for the old woman to eat. (p. 55).

Inferential Thinking

- What do Heidi's actions at Grandmother's house tell us about the kind of person she is becoming?
- Why do you think Grandfather agrees to fix Grandmother's cottage even though no one asked him to?

Tiered Discussion Prompts

Literal: What did Grandfather do to help make Grandmother's cottage safe and warm? | What did the parson say Heidi needed to do the following winter?

Inference: Why do you think Grandmother said the days felt long and dull after Heidi was taken away? | What does Grandfather's anger at Deta suggest about how he really feels about Heidi leaving?

Analysis: How does the author show that Heidi's kindness has the power to change people's lives for the better? | What does the difference between how the villagers see Grandfather and how Grandmother sees him tell us about judging people fairly?

Evaluation: Do you think Grandfather made the right choice when he let Deta take Heidi away? Use details from the chapter to support your answer. | Was it fair of the villagers to judge Grandfather based only on what they saw from a distance? Why or why not?

Analytical Thinking

- How does Heidi act as a bridge between Grandfather and the people around him, such as Grandmother and the parson?
- What pattern do you notice in the way both the parson and Aunt Deta try to get Grandfather to change his mind, and why does neither approach fully work?

Personal Connection

- Have you ever done something kind for someone who was lonely or sad? How did it make both of you feel?
- Have you ever had to leave someone or somewhere you loved? How did that feel, and what helped you feel better?

Answer Key

Words to Know — Answer Key

Word	Definition	Sentence from book (page)	Example sentence
delicate	Easily hurt or made sick; not strong or tough.	"She was very delicate, and would even faint sometimes." (p. 51)	The delicate butterfly landed softly on the flower without making a sound.
fierce	Very strong and wild in a scary or powerful way.	"Sometimes, Grandfather would look out at the fierce wind and say, 'You need to stay inside today, Heidi.'" (p. 38)	The fierce storm knocked over the big tree in our backyard.
frail	Weak and not healthy; easy to break or hurt.	"People in the village only half believed these stories because Grandmother was very old and frail." (p. 57)	The frail little kitten needed extra care and gentle handling.
struggled	Tried very hard to do something that was difficult.	"Heidi Does Heidi have a shawl?" Heidi, already out the door, shouted back, "I don't have one, but I'll be fine." She started running so fast that Peter struggled to keep up." (p. 46)	I struggled to carry all my books up the stairs without dropping any.

Reading Between the Lines — Answers

- **Why might Grandmother feel so much happier after Heidi begins visiting her every day?:** Grandmother is blind and cannot see, so she feels cut off from the world. Heidi's visits bring her stories, laughter, and friendly company, which fill her days with joy and give her something to look forward to, because before Heidi came she used to wish for days to end quickly. (p. 48)
- **What clues show that Grandfather truly cares about Heidi even though he seems gruff and angry?:** Grandfather wraps Heidi warmly before the sled ride, carries her up the hill in his arms at night, keeps a fire going all winter to keep her warm, and fixes Grandmother's cottage because Heidi asked him to, showing he acts with deep care even when his words seem harsh. (p. 46)
- **What does Heidi's quick decision to ask Grandfather to fix Grandmother's house suggest about how she feels toward the old woman?:** Heidi immediately thinks about how to help Grandmother as soon as she gets home, which suggests she already feels a deep and loving bond with the old woman and cares very much about making her life safer and happier. (p. 46)

Dig Deeper — Answers

- **How does Heidi's visit change Grandmother's daily life, and what does this reveal about the power of kindness and friendship?:** Before Heidi's visits, Grandmother wished for days to end quickly and felt only darkness and sadness. After Heidi begins coming every day, Grandmother smiles, laughs, sleeps better, and feels joy, wondering how the time passes so quickly.

This shows that a kind and caring presence can completely transform a person's experience of life, even when their circumstances, such as being blind and frail, have not changed at all. (p. 48)

- **Compare how the parson and Aunt Deta each try to convince Grandfather to let Heidi leave the mountain, and what their different approaches reveal about their reasons for coming.:** The parson speaks gently and with concern for Heidi's education and for Grandfather's soul, offering friendship and encouraging him to make peace with the village. Aunt Deta is pushy and flattering at first, then angry and threatening when Grandfather does not agree. The parson's approach suggests he genuinely cares about both Heidi and Grandfather, while Deta's approach suggests she is more interested in the opportunity for Heidi than in what is truly best for her. (p. 51)
- **What does the way the villagers talk about Grandfather and Heidi's departure reveal about how quickly people can judge others without knowing the full truth?:** The villagers see Heidi running ahead of Deta and assume she is happy to leave Grandfather, not knowing that she is actually running because she wants to bring rolls to Grandmother. They also believe Grandfather is cold and unkind, while Grandmother, who knows the truth, tells them he fixed her house and cared for Heidi well. This shows that people often form judgments based on what they see from the outside, without understanding the real story. (p. 57)

Multiple Choice — Answers

- **Why did Grandmother say she loved Heidi's visits so much?:** B — The text states that Heidi's stories, kind words, and friendly company made Grandmother smile, laugh, and feel joy. The other options describe things that did not happen or are not supported by the text.
- **What was the rich family in Frankfurt looking for when Aunt Deta brought news of the opportunity?:** C — Deta explains that the rich family's daughter could not walk and needed a friend to play and learn with her. The other options describe roles not mentioned in Deta's proposal.
- **What finally made Heidi agree to walk down the mountain with Aunt Deta?:** C — Heidi stopped arguing and began running eagerly after Deta promised she could bring soft white rolls back to Grandmother. The other options are not supported by the text as the reason Heidi agreed to go.

Evidence from the Story — Sample Answers

- **Find a sentence that shows how Grandfather reacted when Aunt Deta told him to be careful about what he did next.:** Grandfather became furious and shouted at Deta, telling her to take Heidi and not bring her back. The text shows his anger through his loud words and the description of his flaming eyes. *Be quiet! Grandfather thundered with flaming eyes. Take her and ruin her, but don't bring her back! I do not want to see her looking all fancy and speaking wicked words the way you do.* (p. 54)
- **What words does Grandmother say that show how lonely and sad she feels after Heidi is taken away?:** Grandmother expresses her deep sadness by saying that all the happiness left when Heidi did and that she no longer feels happy. She also

says she wishes she could hear Heidi's voice one more time. *All the happiness left when Heidi did. The days are so long and dull, and I don't feel happy anymore. I wish I could hear Heidi's voice one more time before I pass away.* (p. 57)

- **Find the words Grandmother speaks that show she wanted someone to read the old prayer book to her.:** Grandmother explains that she has nearly forgotten the songs in her prayer book because no one reads them to her anymore, and she had hoped Peter would learn to read well enough to read them to her. *She had nearly forgotten the songs because no one reads them to her anymore. She hoped Peter could read them to her someday. But she was losing hope that he would ever learn to read well.* (p. 44)

Character Chart — Answer Key

Character	Description	What This Shows	Quote	Page
Heidi	A young girl who lives with her grandfather on the mountain and visits Grandmother eagerly throughout the winter.	Heidi is caring, energetic, and generous. She notices other people's problems and immediately tries to find ways to help them.	Nobody told me, but I know. Poor Grandmother said she was worried the house might fall apart.	46
Grandfather	Heidi's gruff but caring grandfather who lives alone on the mountain and is feared or disliked by many villagers.	Though he seems harsh on the outside, Grandfather acts with deep love and loyalty toward Heidi and is moved by her compassion to help others.	Okay, child, we'll make sure the house won't shake anymore. We can do it tomorrow.	47
Grandmother	Peter's blind and frail grandmother who lives in a rattling cottage and feels lonely and forgotten before Heidi's visits.	Grandmother is gentle and grateful, and she shows how much a small act of kindness can mean to someone who feels isolated and helpless.	All the happiness left when Heidi did. The days are so long and dull, and I don't feel happy anymore.	57
Aunt Deta	Heidi's aunt who arrives looking fancy and tries to convince Grandfather to let her take Heidi to Frankfurt for a wealthy family.	Deta is determined and persuasive but also willing to bend the truth and use flattery or pressure to get her way, suggesting her motives are not entirely selfless.	Don't be stubborn like a goat. We have to go like Grandfather said. If we don't, he'll be even more upset.	54
The Parson	An old friend of Grandfather who visits to talk about Heidi going to school and encourages Grandfather to make peace with the village.	The parson is kind and patient, showing genuine concern for both Heidi's future and Grandfather's well-being without forcing his views on him.	Make your peace with God, and then you'll see how happy you will be.	53

Draw It! — Suggested Details

- Grandfather holding Heidi securely on a large wooden sled as they speed through a sparkling, snow-covered mountain landscape with trees glittering like silver and gold
- Heidi sitting on a small stool beside Grandmother's spinning wheel, holding the old woman's hands and talking cheerfully while Peter's mother sews nearby
- Grandfather on the roof of Grandmother's cottage, hammering and fixing the beams while Heidi comforts the frightened old woman inside
- Aunt Deta in a long fancy dress, pulling Heidi by the hand down the mountain path while Heidi looks back toward the village
- Grandmother leaning out of her window, calling out Deta's name as Heidi and Deta disappear down the path in the distance

Bonus Challenge — Answer Key (Correct Order)

1. Peter visits Heidi at the cottage and tells her that his grandmother would love to meet her.
2. Grandfather wraps Heidi warmly, sets her on the sled, and shoots down through the winter landscape to Peter's hut.
3. Heidi meets Peter's blind grandmother and asks if she can help make things brighter for her.
4. Grandfather promises Heidi he will bring his hammer and nails to fix Grandmother's cottage the next day.
5. The village parson visits Grandfather and tells him Heidi must come to school the following winter.
6. Aunt Deta arrives and tells Grandfather she has found a place for Heidi with a rich family in Frankfurt.
7. Peter runs to tell Grandmother that Deta has taken Heidi away, and Grandmother calls out from the window begging Deta to leave the child.

Differentiated Supports

Struggling Readers

Before reading: Preview the chapter by looking at the illustrations together. Ask: 'What do you see happening in each picture? Who are the people?' | Introduce the four main characters before reading: Heidi, Grandfather, Grandmother, and Aunt Deta. Write their names on the board and say one simple fact about each. | Tell students: 'In this chapter, Heidi visits a kind old woman who cannot see, and then a visitor comes to take Heidi away. Watch for how Heidi feels about both things.'

During reading: Pause after page 43 and ask a literal question: 'Can Grandmother see anything at all?' (Answer: No, she tells Heidi everything is dark for her.) | Pause after page 47 and ask: 'What does Heidi ask Grandfather to do for Grandmother?' (Answer: Fix the loose shutter and the shaking house.) | When Aunt Deta arrives on page 53, ask: 'Where does Deta want to take Heidi?' (Answer: To Frankfurt, to be a friend for a girl who cannot walk.)

After reading: Have students draw two scenes: one showing Heidi helping Grandmother, and one showing Heidi leaving with Deta. Ask them to write one sentence under each picture. | Ask students to point to or read aloud the sentence that shows Grandmother is happy when Heidi visits. (Example: 'She wondered how the time passed so quickly.') | Give students a sentence frame to retell the chapter: 'Heidi visited Grandmother and _____. Then Aunt Deta came and _____.'

English Language Learners

Before reading: Pre-teach four key words with pictures or gestures: fierce (show a strong wind blowing), frail (show a very old, thin person), delicate (handle something gently), struggled (pretend to run very hard but slowly). | Draw a simple map on the board showing the mountain cottage, Peter's grandmother's hut, and the village. Point to each place as you introduce it so students can follow the characters' movements. | Say the names aloud slowly — Heidi, Grandfather, Grandmother, Brigida, Deta — and have students repeat them so they feel comfortable with the names while reading.

During reading: When Grandmother says 'Everything is dark for me,' stop and explain simply: 'Grandmother is blind. She cannot see anything at all, not light, not people, not the snow.' Use a gesture of covering your eyes. | On page 47, when Heidi says they need nails and a hammer, clarify the word 'fix' by miming hammering. Ask: 'What does Heidi want Grandfather to fix?' to check understanding. | When Deta arrives, help students understand the word 'proposal' by saying: 'Deta has a plan — an idea — for Heidi. She wants Heidi to go to a new place and be a friend to a sick girl.'

After reading: Provide a simple sentence frame for a retell: 'Heidi visited Grandmother because _____. Grandfather fixed the house because _____. Heidi left with Deta because _____.' | Ask students to act out a short scene in pairs: one student is Heidi, one is Grandmother. Heidi knocks and says hello; Grandmother asks who is there. Use simple words from the text. | Create a two-column vocabulary chart together. Column 1: Word. Column 2: Draw it or write it in your home language. Use fierce, frail, delicate, and struggled.

Advanced Students

Before reading: Ask students to predict: 'Grandmother is blind and lives in a falling-apart house. What do you think Heidi will do to help her? What can a child actually do for someone who is old and blind?' | Challenge students to think about Grandfather before reading: 'At the start of the book, the villagers thought Grandfather was mean. Based on what you already know, do you agree? What evidence do you have?' | Ask: 'What does it mean to be truly kind to someone? As you read, look for examples of real kindness and ask yourself: why does the character do it?'

During reading: After Heidi cries about Grandmother's blindness (page 43), ask: 'Why does Heidi cry? What does this tell us about her character? How is she different from other children who might have simply moved on?' | After Grandfather fixes the house (page 48), ask: 'Grandfather said he didn't need any thanks. Why do you think he acted gruff but still helped? What does this reveal about who he really is?' | When Deta arrives and argues with Grandfather (pages 53–54), ask students to track both sides of the argument. Who makes stronger points? What does each person want for Heidi, and do their reasons seem selfish or caring?

After reading: Ask students to write a short paragraph comparing two characters: Grandmother and Aunt Deta. How does each woman affect Heidi's life? Use evidence from the text to support their ideas. | Challenge: Grandmother says 'All the happiness left when Heidi did.' Write a journal entry from Grandmother's point of view after Heidi is taken away. Use details from the chapter to make it feel real. | Discussion question: 'The parson and Deta both think Heidi should leave the mountain. Do you think they are right? Use at least two pieces of evidence from the chapter to support your opinion.'

Common Student Questions

1. **Why can't Grandmother see anything?** (p. 43)

The book tells us Grandmother is blind — her eyes cannot see light, people, or anything around her. No one can fix this for her.

2. **Why does Heidi cry when she finds out Grandmother is blind?** (p. 43)

Heidi feels very sad because she loves the sun and the mountains so much, and she cannot imagine never being able to see them. She wants to help but learns she cannot fix Grandmother's eyes.

3. **Why does Grandfather fix Grandmother's house if he is grumpy?** (p. 47)

Heidi asked him with hopeful eyes and he could not say no to her. Even though Grandfather seems grumpy, he is kind to Heidi and wants to make her happy.

4. **Why doesn't Grandfather want Heidi to go to school?** (p. 51)

Grandfather worries the long, cold walk to the village school could make Heidi sick. He also wants her to be free and happy, like a bird.

5. **Why does Aunt Deta take Heidi away even though Heidi says she does not want to go?** (p. 54)

Deta believes Frankfurt is a wonderful opportunity for Heidi and tells her she can come back soon with gifts for Grandmother.

Deta keeps pulling her along and does not listen to Heidi's wishes.

6. **Why doesn't Deta let Heidi stop to say goodbye to Grandmother?** (p. 55)

Deta is in a hurry and worries that if Heidi sees Grandmother, the old woman will convince Heidi to stay and they will miss their chance to go to Frankfurt.

7. **Why does Grandmother feel sad again after Heidi leaves?** (p. 57)

Heidi's visits and stories had made Grandmother's days bright and happy. Without Heidi, the days feel long and dull, and the old woman has nothing to look forward to.

8. **Why do the villagers think Heidi is happy to leave Grandfather?** (p. 57)

They see Heidi running fast down the mountain ahead of Deta. They do not know she is really rushing because she hopes to bring rolls back to Grandmother quickly. They guess she is glad to go.

Creative Response

Common errors

No Specific Details From The Chapter

Some students write about Heidi in a very general way without using details from the chapter. They might say Heidi was kind or that she helped someone, but they do not tell the reader exactly what Heidi said or did. Good writing about a character uses small, clear details from the story to show what the character is like.

Weak example: Heidi was nice to Grandmother and made her feel better.

How to fix: Go back to the chapter and find one thing Heidi said or did. For example, Heidi held Grandmother's hand and tried to lead her outside to show her the light. Use that kind of detail in your writing instead of just saying Heidi was nice.

Breaking Character

Some students write things that Heidi would never say or do based on what we know about her in the story. Heidi is a caring, excited, and hopeful girl who loves the mountains and the people around her. If your writing makes Heidi act cold, lazy, or mean, that does not match who she is in the chapter.

Weak example: Heidi told Grandmother she was too busy to visit and walked away.

How to fix: Before you write, ask yourself: Would Heidi really do this? In the chapter, Heidi cried when she learned Grandmother could not see, and she begged Grandfather to fix the broken house. Make sure your Heidi acts the same caring, hopeful way.

Retelling The Whole Chapter Instead of Focusing on Heidi's Experience

Some students copy what already happened in the chapter instead of writing something new and creative. The prompt asks you to imagine something, not just repeat the story. If your writing only describes what is already on the pages, you are retelling, not creating.

Weak example: Heidi went to Grandmother's house and talked to her. Then Grandfather fixed the shutter. Then Heidi went home.

How to fix: Think beyond the chapter. If the prompt asks what Heidi might say or do in a new moment, make up something new that still fits her character. Use the chapter as a starting point, then let your imagination take over.

No Evidence From the Text

Some students make claims about Heidi that are not supported by anything in the chapter. For example, a student might say Heidi does not care about Grandmother, but the chapter clearly shows the opposite. Your writing should match what the text tells us about Heidi.

Weak example: Heidi did not really care if Grandmother was sad or not.

How to fix: Find a sentence in the chapter that supports what you are saying about Heidi. For example, the chapter says Heidi burst out crying when she learned Grandmother could not see the light. Use that as proof when you describe how Heidi feels.

Modern Language That Doesn't Fit The Story

Some students use very modern words or phrases that do not fit the world of the story. Heidi lives in an old mountain village long ago. She would not use words like awesome, okay cool, or no way. Writing that uses those kinds of words pulls the reader out of the story.

Weak example: Heidi said, 'No way, Grandmother, that is so awesome! Let's totally fix your house!'

How to fix: Look at how Heidi talks in the chapter. She says things like, 'Oh, please, Grandfather, can you fix it for her?' Keep your writing simple and warm, the way Heidi speaks in the story. Avoid slang and phrases from today.

Exit Ticket

Prompt: Predict what will happen next chapter, and explain why using a detail from the text.

Success Criteria

- Makes a prediction about what will happen next
- Uses at least one detail from the text as evidence
- Explains the thinking using the word because

Example Responses

Strong: I predict that Heidi will be very unhappy in Frankfurt because she loves the mountains and her grandfather. The text says Heidi did not want to go and tried to break free from Deta when she heard Grandmother calling her name.

Developing: I think Heidi will go to Frankfurt. Deta took her away at the end of the chapter.

Homeschool Parent Guide

Chapter Snapshot

Winter arrives on the mountain, and Heidi visits Peter's blind grandmother, bringing the old woman great joy. Heidi convinces Grandfather to fix up the grandmother's drafty, falling-apart cottage. Two years pass, and then two visitors arrive: the village parson, who wants Heidi to go to school, and Aunt Deta, who whisks Heidi away to Frankfurt to be a companion for a wealthy girl who cannot walk.

Why this chapter matters: This chapter shows children what it looks like to notice someone else's need and do something about it — Heidi sees the grandmother's broken shutter and cold house and immediately wants to help. It also raises big feelings about belonging and being taken away from the people you love, which makes for rich conversation at home.

Read-Aloud & Pacing Tips

- **Day 1:** Day 1: Read pages 38–48. This covers Heidi's winter days on the mountain, Peter's snowy visit, the sled ride down to Grandmother's hut, and Grandfather fixing the cottage. Stop after Grandfather tucks Heidi in his arms and they leave for home.
- **Day 2:** Day 2: Read pages 50–57. This covers the two visitors — first the parson, then Aunt Deta — and ends with Heidi being taken down the mountain toward Frankfurt while Grandmother calls out from her window.

When to pause:

- After page 43, when Grandmother says 'Nobody can ever show me the light again' — pause and ask your child how they think Heidi feels right now and why she starts crying.
- After page 47, when Grandfather agrees to fix the cottage — pause and ask what Heidi did to convince him, and whether your child thinks Grandfather is as grumpy as people say.
- After page 51, when the parson leaves sadly — pause and ask your child why they think Grandfather refuses to send Heidi to school or move to the village.
- After page 54, when Grandfather storms out after Deta's proposal — pause and ask your child who they think is right: Grandfather or Deta, and why.

Good stopping points:

- Page 44 — Heidi has just promised to ask Grandfather to fix the cottage; a hopeful, calm moment to stop.
- Page 48 — Grandfather has finished fixing the cottage and the section wraps up warmly; a very natural break.
- Page 53 — The parson has left and the first visitor section is complete, before Deta arrives.
- Page 57 — End of the chapter; Grandmother's final sad words make a memorable stopping point.

Discussion Questions

Understanding the story:

- Why did Peter come to visit Heidi one snowy evening? (Because the snow had piled up and he wanted to see Heidi; his grandmother had also told him she would love to meet Heidi.)
- What was wrong with Grandmother's cottage that worried Heidi? (A shutter was hanging loose and banging, the walls rattled and creaked, and cold wind came in through the cracks.)
- Who were the two visitors who came to see Grandfather in the spring? (The old village parson and Heidi's Aunt Deta.)
- Where did Aunt Deta want to take Heidi, and why? (She wanted to take Heidi to Frankfurt to be a companion and playmate for a rich girl who could not walk.)

Thinking deeper:

- Grandmother says that people who cannot see love to listen to friendly words. What does that tell us about why Heidi's visits mean so much to her? (Because Grandmother cannot see the world around her, hearing Heidi talk, laugh, and tell stories is one of the main ways she can feel connected and happy. Heidi's voice and kindness become like light for her.)
- Grandfather tells the parson he wants Heidi to be 'free and happy as a bird.' Do you think that is a good reason to keep her from school, or is the parson right that she needs to learn? What clues in the chapter support your answer? (There is no single right answer here, but the chapter shows Grandfather loves Heidi and worries about her health in bad weather. The parson points out she is growing up and needs to learn. Both have a point, and your child should be able to name evidence for each side.)
- At the end of the chapter, Heidi runs ahead of Deta toward Frankfurt because she is thinking about bringing Grandmother soft white bread rolls. What does this tell us about Heidi's character? (Even when she is being taken somewhere she does not want to go, Heidi is already thinking about how to help someone she loves. It shows she is caring and hopeful even in a hard situation.)

Making personal connections:

- Have you ever noticed that someone needed help, the way Heidi noticed Grandmother's broken shutter? What did you do about it?
- Heidi cried when she found out Grandmother could never see the sunlight again. Is there something that makes you feel very sad when you think about someone missing out on it?
- Heidi did not want to leave the mountain, but Deta said she could come back. Have you ever had to go somewhere you did not want to go? How did it feel, and what helped you feel better?

Tip: there are no wrong answers here — let your child lead.

Simple Activity Option

Kindness Fix-It List

When Heidi visited Grandmother's cottage, she paid close attention and made a list in her head of everything that needed fixing. This activity helps your child practice the same skill of noticing needs around them and thinking of ways to help.

What you need:

- A piece of paper
- Crayons or pencils
- Optional: a ruler to make simple boxes

What to do:

- Draw a simple house outline on your paper, or just fold the paper into two columns.
- On one side, write or draw three things that were wrong in Grandmother's cottage — for example, the noisy shutter, the cold drafts, or the rattling walls.
- On the other side, write or draw what Heidi and Grandfather did to fix each problem.
- Now think about your own home or neighborhood. Can you spot one small thing that needs fixing or one person who might need cheering up?
- Draw or write a plan for what YOU could do to help, just like Heidi did.

Bonus challenge: Write a short note — just two or three sentences — to someone in your life who might feel lonely or left out, the way Grandmother did before Heidi's visits. Deliver the note or read it aloud to them.

- How do you think the person felt when they received your kind words?
- How did it make YOU feel to do something kind for someone else?

Helpful Parent Notes

Content awareness

Blindness and Disability

The chapter deals directly and emotionally with Grandmother's blindness. Heidi becomes very upset when she realizes Grandmother can never see sunlight or the mountains again, and she cries. This is handled tenderly in the text, but sensitive children may need a moment to process it. You might reassure your child that Grandmother still experiences joy through sound, touch, and Heidi's company — the story actually models this beautifully.

Heidi Being Taken Away Without Full Consent

Aunt Deta tricks Heidi into leaving by promising she can return soon with gifts for Grandmother, even though that is not really the plan. Grandmother calls out from her window and Heidi tries to break free. Some children may find this upsetting or may want to talk about whether what Deta did was fair. This is a good opportunity to discuss honesty and what it means to keep a promise.

Vocabulary tips

- **Act it out together** — *For the word 'fierce,' step outside on a windy day (or use a fan) and say, 'This is fierce wind — it's really strong and wild!' Then ask your child to show you a fierce face.*
- **Use a simple comparison** — *For 'delicate,' say, 'You know how a soap bubble breaks if you touch it too hard? Something delicate is like that — it can be hurt easily, like Heidi's mother who could faint.'*

- **Point to it in the story** — For 'frail,' read the sentence aloud — 'Grandmother was very old and frail' — then say, 'Frail means weak and not very strong in the body, like someone who gets tired very easily.'

Words that might need quick explanation

- **fierce:** Very strong and wild in a way that can feel scary — used in this chapter to describe the powerful wind that blows on the mountain.
- **delicate:** Easily hurt or made sick; not very strong in the body — Grandfather uses this word to describe Heidi's mother, who could faint.
- **frail:** Weak and not healthy in the body, usually because someone is very old — used to describe Grandmother at the end of the chapter.
- **struggled:** Had a really hard time doing something even though you tried — Peter struggled to keep up because Heidi was running so fast.
- **parson:** A church leader, like a pastor or minister, who takes care of people in a town or village.
- **gruffly:** Speaking in a rough, low, unfriendly-sounding way — Grandfather said he didn't need any thanks, but he said it gruffly, meaning he sounded a little grumpy even while doing something kind.

Encouragement for Parents

You are doing something truly wonderful by reading this classic story aloud with your child — these are the kinds of books that stay with kids for a lifetime.

Here are some things to remember:

- It is perfectly fine to stop mid-chapter if your child needs a break — picking up where you left off is easy and keeps the story exciting.
- Let your child sit with sad feelings when they come up, like when Grandmother says she can never see the light again — big emotions are part of big stories.
- If your child wants to act out the sled ride or bang on the floor like Grandfather fixing the cottage, let them — movement helps learning stick.
- You do not need to cover every discussion question in one sitting; pick the one or two that feel most natural for your child that day.
- Your child does not need to read perfectly or answer every question correctly — curiosity and conversation are the goals here.
- Heidi's example of noticing others' needs is a great character lesson to point back to throughout the week, even outside of reading time.

You and your child are in good company with Heidi — keep going, and enjoy every page together.

(INSERT NEXT CHAPTER TEASER)

Standards Mapping

Chapter 3: Lesson 03 - In the Grandmother's Hut + Two Visitors

Primary Standards Addressed

Standard Code	Standard Description	How Addressed	Assessment Evidence
RL.3.1	Ask and answer questions to demonstrate understanding of a text, referring explicitly to the text as the basis for the answers.	Students locate specific details from the chapter text to answer literal questions, such as why Grandfather agreed to fix Grandmother's cottage and what Deta promised Heidi to convince her to leave for Frankfurt.	A teacher can observe whether students correctly identify and write answers that point directly to sentences in the chapter, such as Heidi asking Grandfather to fix the loose shutter and Deta's promise of soft white rolls for Grandmother.
RL.3.3	Describe characters in a story (e.g., their traits, motivations, or feelings) and explain how their actions contribute to the sequence of events.	Students examine how Heidi's feelings and actions drive events in the chapter, including how her sadness about Grandmother's blindness motivates her to beg Grandfather to fix the cottage, and how Deta's arrival changes Heidi's situation.	A teacher can observe whether students describe Heidi's motivations and reactions accurately in discussion or written responses, connecting her emotions to specific events such as persuading Grandfather to repair the hut.
RL.3.5	Refer to parts of stories, dramas, and poems when writing or speaking about a text, using terms such as chapter, scene, and stanza; describe how each successive part builds on earlier sections.	The chapter is divided into two named parts — 'In the Grandmother's Hut' and 'Two Visitors' — giving students a clear example of how an author uses sections to organize a longer story around different events and characters.	A teacher can observe whether students can name and explain what each section is mostly about, distinguishing Heidi's visits to Grandmother from the arrival of the parson and Aunt Deta.
W.3.3	Write narratives to develop real or imagined experiences or events using effective technique, descriptive details, and clear event sequences.	Students use the heavily scaffolded creative prompt to write a short narrative from Grandmother's point of view about the moment she hears	A teacher can observe whether students include a clear sequence of events, descriptive details about Grandmother's feelings, and a simple

Standard Code	Standard Description	How Addressed	Assessment Evidence
W.3.4	With guidance and support from adults, produce writing in which the development and organization are appropriate to task and purpose.	Heidi's footsteps at her door for the first time that winter.	closing sentence in their narrative response.
		With sentence starters and word banks provided as scaffolding, students practice writing clear, complete sentences about chapter events, such as why Grandfather fixed Grandmother's cottage or how Deta convinced Heidi to leave.	A teacher can observe whether students produce legible, on-topic sentences that stay focused on chapter events and use the provided scaffolds appropriately.
L.3.4	Determine or clarify the meaning of unknown and multiple-meaning word and phrases based on grade 3 reading and content, choosing flexibly from a range of strategies.	Students use context clues from the chapter sentences to figure out the meanings of vocabulary words such as 'fierce,' 'delicate,' 'frail,' and 'struggled,' all of which appear in their original sentence contexts in the vocabulary section.	A teacher can observe whether students correctly match each vocabulary word to a simple definition and use the surrounding sentence context as evidence for their choice.
L.3.5	Demonstrate understanding of figurative language, word relationships, and nuances in word meanings.	Students explore how the author uses descriptive language and comparisons in the chapter, such as Peter 'melting like a snowman' by the fire and the snow-covered trees looking 'sprinkled with silver and gold.'	A teacher can observe whether students can explain in their own words what these comparisons mean and why the author used them to describe the characters and setting.
SL.3.1	Engage effectively in a range of collaborative discussions (one-on-one, in groups, and teacher-led) with diverse partners on grade 3 topics and texts, building on others' ideas and expressing their own clearly.	Students participate in a class discussion about why Grandfather refused to let Heidi go to school and whether they think he was right, drawing on specific details from the parson's visit in the chapter.	A teacher can observe whether students take turns speaking, listen to classmates, and build on each other's ideas by referencing what actually happened in the chapter during the parson's conversation with Grandfather.

Standard Code	Standard Description	How Addressed	Assessment Evidence
SL.3.3	Ask and answer questions about information from a speaker, offering appropriate elaboration and detail.	Students listen to a partner retell why Aunt Deta wanted to take Heidi to Frankfurt and then ask a follow-up question about the partner's explanation, practicing identifying the main points of what a speaker says.	A teacher can observe whether students can restate their partner's main point accurately and pose a relevant question tied to details from Deta's visit in the chapter.